

The Mercy Meditation

In this practice we plant seeds of mercy, not only for ourselves, but for others as well. For more guidance, see KF teachings from weeks 15 through 19.

Method 1

Take the meditation posture and breathe for 1 minute. Draw your mind away from the events of the day, from the past or the future, or from others. Focus on what is happening inside of your skin. Settle into being present and aware.

And now, reflect on these three questions for about 1 minute each.

1. In what areas am I most critical of myself?

Pause. Take 30 seconds to jot down what came to your mind.

2. For what do I need to forgive myself?

Pause. You might make a note of what came to mind.

3. How do I treat myself when I make a mistake?

Pause and write for 30 seconds.

Now experiment with bringing compassion to yourself in some way. For example, call to mind someone who loves you as you are. This might be someone divine, like God or Jesus, someone human or even another creature. Imagine seeing yourself through their eyes. Observe and rest with whatever comes and practice letting go of judgment. Breathe for 1 minute.

Method 2

Another way to practice the mercy meditation is by holding someone else in your mind, perhaps someone whom you judge harshly.

1. Allow a person to come to mind toward whom you wish to extend mercy.
2. Then reflect upon each of the questions above as they relate to that person, e.g., In What areas am I most critical of this person?
3. Finally, use your imagination in a healthy way to experiment with bringing compassion to this person. For example, call to mind someone divine, like God or Jesus, someone human, or even another creature, who expresses love toward this person as they are today. Imagine seeing them through the eyes of that love. Observe and rest with whatever comes, and as you breathe, practice letting go of judgment.